

- While not all fulfilment warehouses may not give you this option, some of them will take care of your custom packaging needs. They may also be able to hook you up with vendors for the same, given that packaging is what they do day and night. You could use this to create a unique unboxing experience for your customers.

Tips on choosing the right third-party warehousing partner

It always helps to choose a fulfilment partner who understands the needs of your industry. While there is no dearth of third party warehousing partners out there, you need to do your due diligence. A smart thing would be to choose someone who is already working with companies from a similar or the same industry. This would mean that their stocking expertise meets your needs. This is even more important if your product needs any sort of specialised handling. Having a logistics partner who knows their way around your wares is not just an advantage, it is a downright necessity.

Don't let pricing be the only deciding factor. Do your research. Get on the phone with more than just a few warehousing companies. This is not the time to be shy. Ask questions - lots of them. You do not want any surprises when it comes to signing the dotted line. Find the best fit for you, and half the battle is won.

The dreaded "I" - Inventory

Inventory is perhaps one of the most dreaded words when it comes to businesses that deal with physical goods. It means counting, counting and more counting. And where does all this counting get you? Let's find out.

Inventory management could make or break your business. If you load up stock on a product that isn't selling, it might leave you with little or less space for a product that is doing much better. And what happens when you overstock a product? You might be stuck with dead stock - stuff that is either past its expiry date or is no longer in vogue. A good inventory management system is of the utmost importance when it comes to ensuring that your warehousing needs are in sync with your business needs.

While there are inventory management systems available that can help you track your products and goods, there are other techniques that every small business owner ought to live by to ensure that they maximise their profits, especially from third party warehousing or their own.

- Set a 'minimum' number for your goods. So ensure that at any point in time, the set minimum number of products are available in your inven-